A secret note from the MEA dated 21 August 1975 sent to the PMO and R&AW headquarters said:

As far as India is concerned, we have serious reservations about the brutal manner in which power was seized by the Bangladesh Army but it is not for us to comment on the internal affairs. Our relations with that country, as with others, are based strictly on the principle of equality, respect for mutual sovereignty and non-interference. We have never sought any exclusive relationship with Bangladesh. Bangladesh has as much a right as anyone else to have as many friends as possible. So long as Bangladesh's friendship with Pakistan, China or any other country is in the interest of Bangladesh and not aimed against India, we would not

worry. If on the other hand, Bangladesh becomes a prey to foreign influence detrimental to India's interests, and if it presses its new pro-Islamic posture to a point where the minorities panic and begin to flee to India in large numbers, then that would be cause for grave concern for us. Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Bangladesh has sent us a note that gives a gist of new President Khondaker Mostaq Ahmad's address to the nation where he affirmed his government's resolve to promote Bangladesh's relations, goodwill, understanding and cooperation with all countries.

But India was worried. Not just about the influence of foreign powers in Bangladesh but also about the penetration of non-state actors in a country that had been liberated by Indian spies. In a secret note, government officials analysed what went wrong considering both internal and external factors.

Internal Factors Included: